



Altai is the one governed door that lets a **sealed, air-gapped enterprise AI agent** reach the open, blocked, and dark web, then bring back **signed, tradeable intelligence**. The firm never touches the wire.

PARIS BUILDS 2026 · SOFTWARE FOR AGENTS

Malena · Gabriel · Emile · Louis · Dung Vo · github.com/Symbioose/yc-hackathon

— PROBLEM

The smartest AI agent at a hedge fund isn't allowed to open a web page.

- Every desk is standing up **internal AI agents** for research. The CISO seals them: **no outbound internet**. That is the correct security posture.
- But the signal that **moves a stock** (breaches, leaks, dark-web chatter, filings before they're news) lives **outside the wall**, exactly where the agent can't go.
- Today's workaround is a human analyst: **slow, risky, and not first**.
- **First mover takes the trade. Everyone else reads the press release.**



Internal agent · sealed by the CISO

× no outbound internet

the wall

WHERE THE SIGNAL IS

▸ Open + firewall-blocked web

▸ Breach & leak data

▸ Dark-web chatter · filings

— WHY NOW

For the first time, all three are true at once.

01 · THE AGENTS WENT INTERNAL

Sealed agents are everywhere in 2026.

Enterprises now run internal AI agents on real workflows. The air-gap (no outbound network) has become **default CISO policy**. The wall just went up around every desk.

02 · THE BUDGET EXPLODED

\$17.78B → \$143.87B by 2031.

67% of the buy-side already deploys alternative data; **94%** are increasing spend. Alpha from public data is decaying, so they pay up to be first.

Mordor Intelligence · Lowenstein Sandler
2024

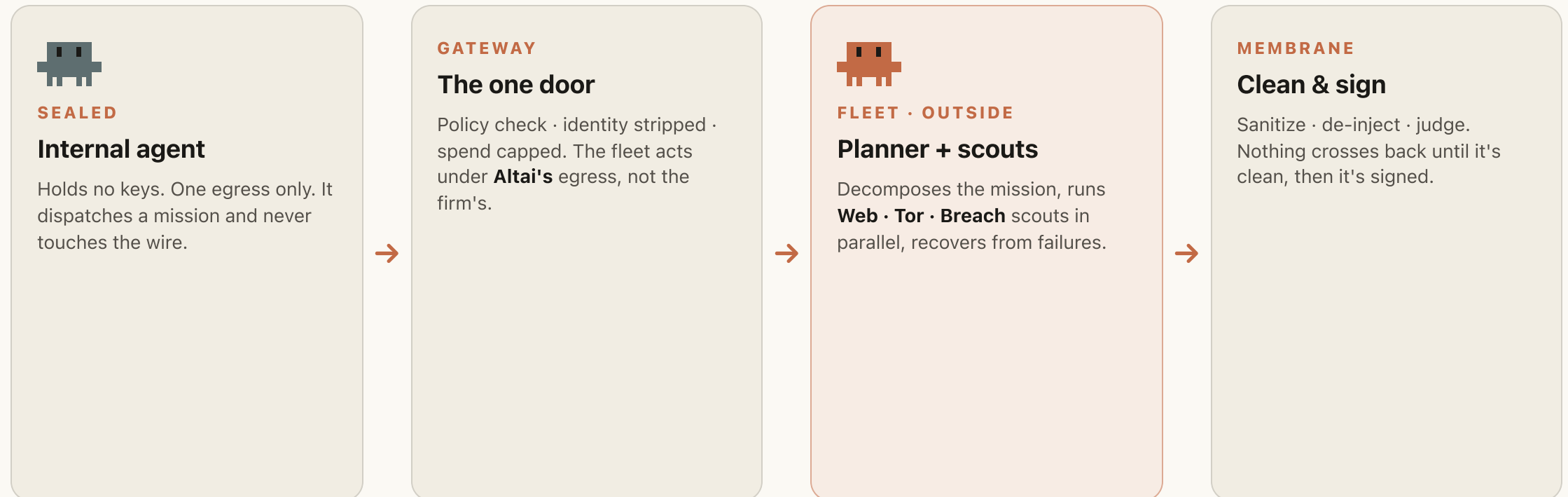
03 · THE CATEGORY IS FUNDED

Capital is rushing the agent perimeter.

Runlayer raised **\$30M** (Felicis, Khosla) in **June 2026** to govern what agents touch. The control plane is being built. **The egress door isn't.**

TechCrunch · Fortune, Jun 2026

One audited door. A fleet does the dangerous part. A signed brief comes back.



Back comes a **signed, sourced brief**, verified **inside** the air-gap (Ed25519 + Merkle). Real multi-step autonomy, and an honest inconclusive @ 0 when there's nothing, never fabricated.

Altai knew nine days before the company told the market.

9 days

ahead of public disclosure, on the recorded demo case.

AIR-GAP IS REAL

curl from the sealed box times out.
Not a mockup.

CONFIDENCE 0.93

Fused over 3 independent sources
(noisy-OR).

TAMPER-EVIDENT, ON CAMERA

Edit one audit entry → the seal
breaks live.

QUANTIFIED

The stock fell **~14%** over the
disclosure window.

The question: **has Northwind Logistics been breached?** Public web showed nothing. The **Tor Scout** found its customer database for sale on a dark-web forum; the **Breach Scout** matched a fresh dump. The membrane caught a **prompt-injection** in the post, quarantined it, signed the brief.

**A risky dark-web signal → one a desk can compliantly trade on.
Every step is in the signed ledger.**

— MARKET

We sell to the people who pay the most to be first.



▲ 51.91% CAGR · alternative-data market

Source: Mordor Intelligence, Alternative Data Market 2026–2031

67% → 94%

of the buy-side already use alt-data, and 94% are raising budgets. Traditional alpha is eroding. (Lowenstein Sandler, 2024)

~\$1.5B

serviceable today. Bottom-up: ~150k analyst seats that need external intelligence × (seat + consumption).

€25M ARR

at 10,000 seats + consumption. We land the first ~1,000 seats (~€2.5M) on the event-driven desks who feel the pain first.

STEP 1 · NOW

Hedge-fund & trading desks

The wedge: sharpest pain, highest willingness to pay, the core of the 51.91% CAGR.



STEP 2 · NEXT

All of finance

Banks (deal & counterparty intel), then cyber-insurers. Same product, more buyers.



STEP 3 · THE VISION

Every air-gapped agent

The governed egress layer for every sealed enterprise agent. Finance was the wedge.

— BUSINESS MODEL

Land per seat. Grow on usage. Search DNA compounds the margin.

WHO PAYS

PM / Head of Research on an event-driven or multi-strategy desk. They already spend **\$100K–\$500K/yr** per alternative-data source.

PRICING

€2,500 /yr per seat

Then **pay-per-investigation** in **Intelligence Units**, metered like cloud compute, not a flat license. Enterprise & on-prem tiers on top.

Quick check
≈ 55 IU

Full diligence
≈ 2,000 IU

Search DNA → margin compounds

Every investigation records the route that worked. The next similar one **reuses it** instead of re-exploring, at a fraction of the compute.

IU / INVESTIGATION

2,000 → 1,200

COST TO FULFIL

\$900 → \$350

GROSS MARGIN

55% → 80%

more searches → richer Search DNA → cheaper searches → higher margin → **repeat**

Each rival wins its own lane. Altai is the only one that does all six.

	Altai us	Runlayer agent control plane	Recorded Future dark-web intel	AlphaSense AI finance research
Governed egress for air-gapped agents	✓	~	—	—
Reaches closed / dark-web sources	✓	—	✓	—
Agent-native, on-demand (no human analyst)	✓	✓	—	~
Cryptographic signed provenance	✓	—	—	—
Finance-grade tradeable signal	✓	—	~	✓
Adversarial inbound membrane	✓	~	—	—

Each is copyable on its own. **Nobody packages all six.** That's the moat: **Runlayer** governs what your agent can touch, **Recorded Future** feeds your analysts; **Altai** lets your sealed agent ask the outside world a question and get back a **signed, tradeable answer it can trust.**

Our first ten customers are two intros away.

- 1 **Beachhead:** 5–10 event-driven / multi-strat desks in London & Paris. The funds that live or die on being first to a credit event.
- 2 **Warm doors:** Malena (ex-Rothschild, hedge-fund analyst) opens her former desks; a CentraleSupélec Head of Special Projects adds a second intro path to clients. No cold outbound. We walk in known.
- 3 **Land:** 1 analyst seat (€2,500) + a paid pilot investigation pack per desk. A 3-desk design-partner cohort running **real signed briefs** their compliance can keep.
- 4 **Expand:** seats spread across the desk once one PM trades on a brief and wins.

First €10–25K in weeks, not quarters.

Three design-partner desks, each a seat + a pilot pack. We don't sell data. We sell the **proof**: the signed ledger is what makes a dark-web signal compliantly tradeable. That's the line item that gets a "yes."

✓ **Problem already pressure-tested with quants at QRT.**

One brief that front-runs a disclosure pays the seat for years. The ROI math closes the sale.

— WHY US

The buyer, the quants, and the engineers. One team.



Malena

ESSEC · ex-Rothschild · ex-HF analyst



Gabriel

six-figure exit · UWaterloo Eng · prev founder



Emile

AI & SWE @ EPITA · prev founder



Louis

CS & Math · Rutgers



Dung Vo

CS · Sorbonne

✓ Validated with quants at **QRT** · client intros via a **CentraleSupélec** Head of Special Projects

SEARCH DNA: IT COMPOUNDS

Every mission teaches the fleet the route that worked. A copycat starts from zero; the gap widens daily. **Defensible beyond any base model.**

TRUST: EARNED, NOT SHIPPED

Being the **audited, compliantly-tradeable** source is won per regulator. Once a desk's compliance leans on our ledger, switching means re-validating.

The crypto is copyable in a weekend. The **compounding system** (Search DNA + compliance trust + governed dark-source access) isn't.

Today the trading desks. Next, **every regulated enterprise that air-gaps its agents**: banks, defense, pharma, energy.

Altai: the governed door to the outside world.

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